[Metric]
A-A-3072
December 8, 1997

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
FILE FOLDERS, DRAWER
(VARIOUS CUTS)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all Federal Agencies which replaces Federal Specification UU-F-1206 which has been canceled.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers 2 types, 4 grades, 2 sizes of various cut drawer, file folders (without fasteners), which have an expansion 9.53 mm to 25.4 mm (3/8 to 1 inches) that are used for document filing.

2. Classification:

Type:	I. - General Purpose	
	II. - Special Purpose	
Grade:	A. - Extra-Heavy Duty	{25 Point}
	B. - Heavy Duty	{17 Point}
	C. - Standard Duty	{11 Point}
	D. - Light Duty	{9.5 Point}
Class:	1. - With Fasteners	
	2. - Without Fasteners	
Size:	A. - Letter	{298.5 x 241.3 mm [11.750 x 9.5 inches]}
	B. - Legal	{374.7 x 241.3 mm [14.750 x 9.5 inches]}
	C. - Custom	As Specified

3. Salient Characteristics:

3.1 Material. The files folders as cited in this commercial item description shall be comprised from fibrous, cellulose materials and conform to the physical properties as specified Table I.

3.1.1 Paperboard. The paperboard used for each grade shall be as follows: Grade A - Extra Heavy Duty (Pressboard); Grade B - Heavy Duty (Kraft or Manila); Grade C - Standard Duty (Kraft or Manila) and Light Duty (Manila) as specified in Table I.

3.1.2 Grain. The grain of the paperboard shall be parallel to the short side of the folder when held in its closed position, when tested as specified in accordance with Table II.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7530

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Table I.
Physical Properties

Characteristics	Grade A Extra-Heavy Duty Pressboard	Grade B Heavy Duty Kraft or Manila	Grade C Standard Duty Kraft or Manila	Grade D Light Duty Manila
Basis Weight (24 x 36 x 500)	602.16 g/m2 370 pounds	353.16 g/m2 217 pounds	239.24 g/m2 147 pounds	216.45 g/m2 133 pounds
Tolerance	-5% + 8%	-5% + 8%	-5% + 8%	-5% + 8%
Thickness	.635 mm (.025 iinch)	.432 mm (.017 inch)	.279 mm (.011 inch)	2.413 mm (.095 inch)
Tolerance	± .00381 mm (± .0015 inch)	± .00381 mm (± .0015 inch)	- .00254 mm + .00127 mm (- .001" + .0005")	± .00127 mm (± .0005 inch)
Stiffness (gurley / min)				
MD, gm	36,000	11,200	3,300	2,200
CD, gm	11,700	4,400	1,200	700
Smoothness (max.) Sheffield Felt / Wire	200	220	200	200
Bursting Strength, min. avg., lb./Sq. in.	180			
Tear, total of both directions		800	500	475

Table II.
Testing of Components

Paperboard Characteristic	Specification Referenced
Sampling	Par. 5.1.1 - TAPPI T 400
Grain	Par. 3.1.2 - TAPPI T 409
Basis Weight	Table I - TAPPI T 410
Thickness	Table I - TAPPI T 411
Tearing Resistance, Total - Both Directions	Table I - TAPPI T 414
Stiffness	Table I - TAPPI T 543
Smoothness	Table I - TAPPI T 538
Bursting Strength	Table I - TAPPI T 807
Cloth Gusset	ASTM - D - 1424
Spunbonded Polyolefin Gusset	ASTM - D - 1922
Laminated Sheeting Gusset	ASTM - D - 1004

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3.1.3 Gusset Material. Folders fabricated from grade A paperboard shall have the front and back leaves joined by a gusset material listed below at the option of the manufacture. The color of the gusset shall be complimentary to the paperboard color, and shall compare favorably in color, hue, and intensity to gusset material used in the commercial production of similar file folders. The gusset shall be two-ply with the end (on the width) joined on the inside so that there is at least a 6.35 mm (1/4 inch) overlap. The gusset shall provide for an expansion of 25.5 mm ± 3.18 mm (1 inch ± 1/8 inch), with one fold inward and parallel to the leaves. The gusset material shall be glued on each side of the leaves over a width not less than 12.70 mm (1/2 inch) and not more than 25.4 mm (1 inch). The gusset shall be firmly glued to the folder so that its removal results in paperboard failure and not the adhesive bond failure.

3.1.3.1 Cloth Gusset Material. If used, the cloth gusset shall be well sized and filled so that the fold does not lose shape or flatten out when the folder is used. The cloth shall have a thread count of not less than 60 threads in the warp and not less than 50 threads in the filling when tested in accordance with ASTM D 1424. The cloth gusset (two plies of cloth) shall have an Elmendorf Tearing Strength of not less than 900 grams in the long direction (when folder is held in the closed position).

3.1.3.2 Spunbonded Polyolefin Gusset Material. If used, the file folder gusset mater specified shall be made from two plies of Spunbonded Polyolefin material which shall not lose its shape or flatten out in use. The Spunbonded Polyolefin gusset shall have an Elmendorf Tearing Strength of not less than 400 grams in the long direction (when the folder is held in the closed position) when tested in accordance with ASTM D 1922.

3.1.3.3 Laminated Sheeting Gusset Material. If used, the file folder with laminated gusset sheeting shall have a minimum thickness of 1.0 mil or as specified in the contract or ordering document. The material shall not lose its shape or flatten out in use. The laminated sheeting material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM 1004 and yield a force no less than 500 grams-force.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Type I & II File Folders. Type I & II file folders, drawer shall be fabricated from grade boards as specified in paragraph 3.1.2. The folders shall be formed by folding the board to form a front and back leaf. The dimensions on the front and back leaf shall be as specified for the applicable size in the contract or ordering document. The front leaf shall be scored 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) expansion at 9.53 mm (3/8) or 6.35 mm (1/4 inch) intervals across the bottom width of the folder. Unless otherwise specified, Type I folders with straight-cut tabs shall be scored on the tab using two single lines to show the position of 1/3 cut tabs. All top corners of the folders shall be rounded (Rounded corners may include "S" Curves).

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3.2.2 Grade A Folders. Grade A folders shall be constructed of two leaves of grade A paperboard in accordance with table I of this commercial item description, joined by one piece gusset material as specified in paragraph 3.1.3. The gusset material shall provide for an expansion of one or two inches between the leaves as specified in the contract or ordering document. The edges of the front leaves shall be paralleled to the corresponding edges of the back leaves.

3.2.3 Grade B Folders. Grade B folders shall be fabricated from grade B paperboard in accordance with table I of this commercial item description. The folders shall be formed by folding the board to form a front and back leaf. The gusset material shall provide for an expansion of one or two inches between the leaves as specified in the contract or ordering. The edges of the front leaves shall be paralleled to the corresponding edges of the back leaves. The front leaf shall be scored 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) expansion at 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) or 6.35 mm (1/4 inch) interval across the bottom width of the folder. The tab portion (top) of the back leaf, for all size folders shall be scored for 1/3 cut positions.

3.2.4 Grade C Folders. Grade C folders shall be fabricated from grade C paperboard in accordance with table I of this commercial item description. The folders shall be formed by folding the board to form a front and back leaf. The front leaf shall be scored 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) expansion at 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) or 6.35 mm (1/4 inch) interval across the bottom width of the folder.

3.2.5 Grade D Folders. Grade D folders shall be fabricated from grade D paperboard in accordance table I of this commercial item description. The folders shall be constructed as specified. The dimensions of the front and back leaves shall be as specified in the contract or ordering document.

3.3 Dimensions.

3.3.1 Size A, B & C. The height and width of both the front and back leaves shall be as specified in the contract or ordering document. A tolerance of ± 1.59 mm (1/16 inch) shall apply to all dimensions cited.

3.4 Tabs.

3.4.1 Double Top Tab (if required). The back leaf of the folder shall be reinforced along the top or side tab edge, as applicable. The reinforcing material shall be the same stock as the folder and shall be 28.58 mm (1 1/8 inches), 1.59 mm ± (1/16 inch) in total width, including the tab and measured from the edge of the tab; extending the full length of the folder edge. The reinforcement shall be securely glued to the inner portion of the folder back leaf.

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3.4.2 Straight Plastic Tabs. When tab is viewed from the side, the front portion of the plastic tab shall form an angle of 12° ± 5° with the self tab. The point where the front of the plastic tab extends furthest from the surface of the self tab shall not be less than 2.38 mm (3/32 inch), outside dimension. The title insert window shall have a 9.53 mm (3/8 inch), minimum face height.

3.4.3 Self Tabs. Self tabs shall be a horizontal extension of the back leaf.. The tab corners shall be rounded which may include S curves.

3.4.4 Plastic Tabs. Plastic tabs shall be fabricated from cellulose acetate, polyvinyl chloride, or other suitable plastic, having a film thickness not less than 0.25 mm (0.01 inch). The plastic tab shall envelope the self tab to within 1.59 mm (1/16 inch) of the curve side of the self tab. The plastic tab shall accommodate paper inserts which are in accordance with the requirements of paragraph 3.5 and hold the insert supplied with the folders. The plastic tab shall be attached firmly to the folder by solvent or heat sealing, so that its removal results from paperboard failure and not from sealing failure.

3.4.5 Angular Plastic Tabs. When the tab is viewed from the side, the front portion of the plastic tab shall form a angle of 45° ± 10° with the self tab. The point where the front of the plastic tab extends furthest from the surface of the outside dimension of the self tab shall not be less than 3.18 mm (1/8 inch) (outside dimension). The title insert window of the tab shall have a 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) minimum face height.

3.4.6 Metal Tab, General. The metal tabs shall be made of steel 0.33 mm to 0.36 mm (0.0128 to 0.0141 inch) thick (29 gage, manufacturer's standard gage). All corners shall be rounded, and there shall be no sharp projections. The tabs shall be treated or coated so as to present a black eggshell finish. The coating shall be smooth, continuous, flexible, tough, and hard. The metal tabs shall be attached to the folder by a minimum of three eyelet's. The **Self-Eyelet** type attachment is acceptable, provided the attachment does not have rough edges or projections interfering with users safety, or the protection of the paper enclosed in he file folder.

3.4.7 Angular Metal Tabs. A metal tab finished as in paragraph 3.4.4 in the shape of a rectangular projection top with a triangular attachment base shall have an overall height of not less than 50.8 mm (2 inches), with a projection height of not more than 15.88 mm (5/8 inch). The tab shall contain a front window opening a minimum of 9.53 mm (3/8 inches) less than the length of the tab. For 1/3 cut angular metal tabs, the window opening shall be 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) minimum height by 88.9 mm (3 1/2 inches) minimum length. For 1/5 cut angular metal tabs, the window opening shall be 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) minimum in height an 44.45mcm (1 3/4 inches) minimum in length. Both the 1/3 cut and 1/5 cut angular metal tabs shall be constructed so that an insert will be held firmly in place but can be removed. The back of the tab shall be slotted to facilitate insertion and removal of inserts. The tabs shall be furnished with a transparent, clear, colorless cellulose acetate fastened by eyelet's (for self-eyelet attachments, see paragraph 3.4.4) in the triangular base to the back leaf long dimension.

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3.4.8 Rectangular Metal Tab. The rectangular metal tab shall have equi-dimension openings for front window openings. The bottom of the tab shall be closed. The overall length shall be not less than 98.43 mm (3 7/8 inches) with a projection height of not more than 15.875 mm (5/8 inch). The overall length shall be not less than 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) greater than the length of the window openings. For 1/3 cut rectangular metal tabs, the window opening shall have a minimum height of 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) and minimum length of 88.9 mm (3 1/2 inches). For 1/5 cut rectangular metal tabs, the window opening shall be 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) minimum in height, and 44.45 mm (1 3/4 inches) minimum in length. The tab shall be furnished with transparent window covers of equi-dimension for front and back windows. Rectangular metal tabs shall be fastened by eyelet's (for self-eyelet type attachment, see paragraph 3.4.4.

3.5 Inserts. A sufficient number (equal to folders in box, or up to 33 % overage) of blank white paper inserts for metal or plastic tabs shall be furnished in perforated strips so they can be inserted through a typewriter and then readily detached from the strip. These inserts shall be the width of the tab for which they were designed, + 1.59 mm (1/16) or - 3.18 mm (1/8 inch). If preprinted paper inserts are specified they shall be banded and attached with the blank white inserts to the top folder of each box. Inserts fit in the tabs that they are designed for, without use of tape or excessive bowing. Excessive bowing is defined as that which makes legibility difficult.

3.6 Punching. When punching is required, file folders shall be furnished with punched holes. The contract or purchase order shall specify location and dimensions of punched holes.

3.7 Workmanship. Folders shall be clean and free from hard shives, dirt spots, holes, blisters, tears, or wrinkles and shall have a smooth uniform finish. Edges shall be cleanly cut, without nicks or ragged edges. Die cuts to make the rounded corners may remain as long as they can be easily removed with little or no effort. Folders shall be free from any other defects which may affect their serviceability or appearance.

4. Regulatory Requirements: The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 20% Postconsumer fiber as defined by the Paper Products Recovered Materials Advisory Notice (Paper RMAN) and the Executive Order 12995 dated March 25, 1996. The Paper RMAN is found in the Federal Register, Vol. 61, Part IV dated May 29, 1996.

4.1 Labeling of Recycled Content. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

4.2 Bleaching: To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this commercial item description, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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5. Quality Assurance Provisions:

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.1.1 Testing. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the referenced tests in this Commercial Item Description. (Note: See TAPPI T400 for specific sampling instructions and acceptance criteria).

6. Packaging:

6.1 Packaging, packing, marking, and palletization shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Part Identification Number (PIN). The following part identification numbering procedure is for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

This example describes a part numbering system for CID **A-A-3072**

A-A- 2 A 2 C — Example of reference part number for an file folder, drawer

	Size:	A. Letter
		B. Legal
		C. Custom
	Class:	1. - With Fasteners
		2. - Without Fasteners
	Grade:	A. Extra-Heavy Duty
		B. Heavy Duty
		C. Standard Duty
		D. Light Duty
	Type:	1 - Type I - General Purpose
		2 - Type II - Special Purpose

7.2 Source of Documents. The following documents form a part of the Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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7.2.1 Copies of Executive Order 12995 may be obtained from: The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building, White House, Att: Publications, Washington, DC. 20500 (202) 395-7332.

7.2.2 The Final (Paper RMAN) is available from the Environmental Protection Agency's public access server on the Internet or from the RCRA Hotline. The Hotline can be reached toll-free at (800) 424-9346.

7.2.3 Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) test methods cited in this CID may be obtained from TAPPI, Technology Park, PO Box 105113, Atlanta, Georgia, 30348-5113.

7.2.4 Copies of the appropriate ASTM's may be obtained from the American Standards for Testing Materials at 100 Barr Harbor Dr., West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

7.3 **Ordering Data:** Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A - Title, number and date of this specification.
B - Type, Class, Grade, and Style required.
C - Width of leaves required.
D - Whether bleaching without use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or chlorine compound is required.

7.4 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN's).** The following is a list of nsn's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the CID.

7530-00-281-5941	7530-00-281-5939	7530-00-286-8570
7530-00-281-5942	7530-00-281-5940	7530-00-286-8571
7530-00-282-2507	7530-00-281-5940	7530-00-286-6925
7530-00-282-2508	7530-00-286-6978	7530-00-286-6926
7530-00-281-5945	7530-00-281-5968	7530-00-286-6923
7530-00-281-5960	7530-00-281-5908	7530-00-286-6924
7530-00-281-5959	7530-00-286-7286	7530-00-286-7080
7530-00-281-5938	7530-00-286-7287	7530-00-286-7253

Military Interests:

Military Custodians.
Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review Activities.
Air Force - 84

User Activity.
Army - AV

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA - FSS
NASA - JFK

Preparing Activity:
GSA - FSS (2FYEE)

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8. **Figure.**

STANDARD FASTENER POSITIONS

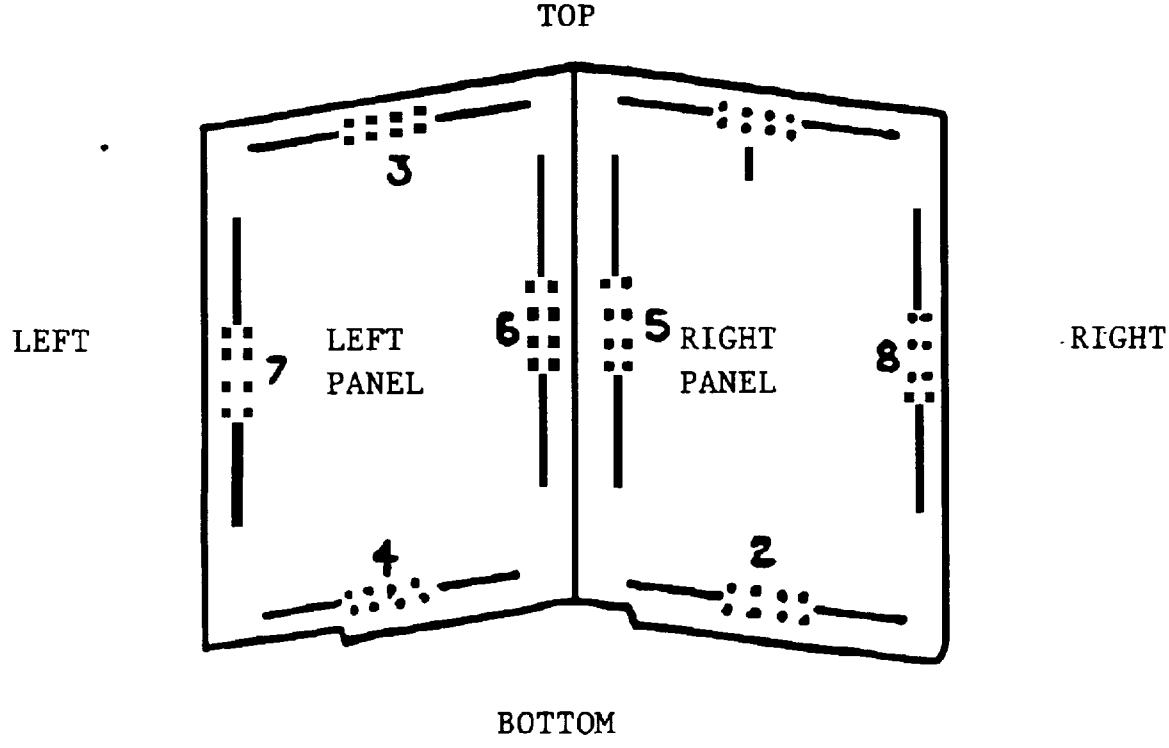


Figure I

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